

The Mistweir is a great cloud that covers the entire border between the Far and Deep Dreaming. It's extremely thick, ranging from a foot in some locations to further than a mile in others. Commoners, claiming to have left Arcadia to escape the conflict between sidhe, have set up towns and hamlets along the barrier over the centuries, and most of them are in the thrall of Bedlam. The largest populated location is the great city of Fin Bheara, named after the boggan settler who founded it. All sorts of Kithain and chimera live there, even sidhe who were left outside the gates when they closed during the Shattering.

Fin Bheara adheres to the ancient tradition of shared rulership, with a dark-haired sidhe queen ruling one half of the year, and Fin Bheara himself ruling during the second part. In the same way, Seelie and Unseelie mingle and follow ancient traditions of the courts that those in the mundane world have long since forgotten. The fact that both sides live according to ancient rules also means that the old conflicts are as strong as they ever were, and politics is a deadly game in the otherwise peaceful city.

Many adventurers use Fir Bheara as their starting point for the quest to penetrate the Mistweir, due to the proximity to aid and supplies. Once they truly enter the barrier there's little hope of finding the way back, and the only means of travel is to go forward until dying or emerging on the other side. Exactly what sort of trials exist inside the mist barrier varies, but they often expose changelings to their most mundane weaknesses and force them to overcome the difficulties by relying on the dreams they're born out of. It's not uncommon to face enigmas with such simple answers that challengers overthink them and end up paralyzed by adding layers of complexity. Most of those trials end in tragedy and the only way out is to either accept fate, or try to change it by circumventing the events like a legendary faerie trickster. No matter what trials and challenges the travelers overcome, once they emerge out of the Mistweir they're strong enough to face the obstacles that await them in the Deep Dreaming.

Everything is possible inside the Deep Dreaming. Kithain constantly combat ancient minions of darkness. Atlantis exists at the bottom of the deepest and darkest sea imaginable, and songs and legends long forgotten still echo and have life throughout the realm. It's the purest, most primal, place the Kithain know of. Everything ranging from colors to impressions are taken to the extreme, and already strong emotions, such as love, can end in horror if a relationship is broken. Nightmare realms are truly horrifying and only the bravest of changelings would even dare to face the threats within. In the Deep Dreaming even the Silver Path is but a memory because it's not needed; the realm sustains the roads with its own Glamour. The realm is kept alive by those mortals who truly believe with all their souls in the old legends, and who only forget about the existence of giants and monsters during the waking hours. Thus this mythical realm is constantly renewed in an endless cycle of change and, despite the fact that locations often switch places, the majority remain in existence eternally.

Example location: Ruins of the First Empire

Long before the Age of Faerie came to an end, a massive floating island, above the High Court of Arcadia, acted as a retreat and diplomatic meeting place for the faeries of nature. Massive mountain ranges housed the children of stone, while its exquisitely-carved cavern system left the landscape immersed in a perpetual, tranquil melody due to the neverending movement of the air-born. Indeed, the island consisted of everything from magma pools and small volcanoes to raging rivers, babbling brooks, and lush forests.

Its whereabouts in the Deep Dreaming is unknown, although Autumn Fae occasionally stumble over poems, cries for help in an ancient tongue, or even rudimentary maps that all provides clues or indications about where to find it. Today, nightmare chimera, escaped from their mountain prisons, roam the landscape, waiting for signs of the Elder Dark's return, while the memories of those who created the beautiful music immerse the land in an everlasting tune of dread, instilling listeners with the sadness of losses past and those to come.

TRODS

What are trods but roads by another name? They act as the pathways upon which changelings can travel to, and within, the Dreaming. Trods reflect the core essence of a journey. They're the paths taken in the Iliad, reflections of investigations into murders and mysteries by literary characters as Hercule Poirot or Lord Peter Wimsey, or manifestations of historical occurrences that continue to fascinate humanity.

Although trods existed during the Mythic Age, the Sundering showed their true importance. During the Shattering, sweeping disbelief and stagnation caused lasting harm to the infrastructure of the Dreaming, leaving wayfarers stranded within nightmares, unsealing ancient curses on trods, or even trapping fae on roads fraught with Banality-infected traps. While the Dreaming continued to purge the "infection" from its plane, it was simply too dangerous to use the few remaining trods connected to the Autumn Realm.

The Renaissance produced enough Glamour to begin stabilizing existing pathways, and it continued to accumulate during the following centuries. Towards the end of the 18th century, the Kithain commenced construction of households in the Near Dreaming again. By the mid-19th century a few Far and Deep Dreaming trods reemerged, taking travelers into new dream realms born out of the Industrial Revolution and the works of writers like Jane Austen and Jules Verne.

The Resurgence made it possible to truly explore all three layers of the Dreaming again. Long-lost realms and pathways returned in full glory alongside the majestic display of Arcadian trods. Changelings across the world experienced the pathways' reconnection through the increased Glamour flow at the time. However, due to the world's accumulated Banality, no trod leading to Arcadia remains stable long enough to travel there.